

AMSS 2026 — Lab 6: Project Workshop + Cold-Defense Dry Run

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2026

Lab 6: Workshop + Dry Run

Two phases, 100 minutes — **the full rehearsal for Week 14.**

1. **Team workshop** (~50 min) — supervised work; close the gaps from the Lab 5 checkpoint.
2. **Cold-defense dry run** (~50 min) — the instructor picks students **at random** and drills the three defense skills: Critique, Rationale, Traceability.

Deliverable: **dry-run feedback** — informal, but every gap surfaced must be fixed before Week 14.

What the Dry Run Is

- ▶ A **full cold defense** — unaided, no AI, no slides.
- ▶ The instructor calls on students **at random** and asks Critique / Rationale / Traceability questions about their slice.
- ▶ **Ungraded** — but treated as the real thing. Gaps become your pre-Week 14 checklist.

Random Selection — Be Ready Cold

You don't know **when** you'll be called or **which** question you'll get.

- ▶ The examiner may show **another team's** diagram for a Critique question.
- ▶ You can't rehearse a script — you rehearse the *skills*.

That's the point: Week 14 is the same.

The Questions You Might Get

- ▶ **Critique** — “Read this diagram. What’s wrong?” (yours or another team’s)
- ▶ **Rationale** — “Why did you direct AI this way? What did you reject?”
- ▶ **Traceability** — “Walk this requirement to its test.” / “Which requirement needs this class?”

Recall the strong answers: read aloud + fix; reason not authority; walk the trace and name a link you fixed.

Use the Workshop Time

The first 50 minutes: close the gaps from your **Lab 5 checkpoint**.

- ▶ Re-run your **trace audit** — any broken links left?
- ▶ Re-read every diagram in your slice — practise critiquing it **aloud**.
- ▶ Rehearse your **rationale** for each real decision.

How to Use the Feedback

When you're called, you'll get **specific, actionable** feedback:

- ▶ what landed, what didn't;
- ▶ which defense skill you're weakest on (Critique, Rationale, or Traceability);
- ▶ the exact gap to close before Week 14.

Write it down. This is your **Week 14 checklist**.

Watch Others Defend

You learn as much watching as being called:

- ▶ Spot the **strong moves** (reading a multiplicity aloud, naming a fixed link).
- ▶ Spot the **red flags** (“the AI said it was good”) — and make sure they’re not yours.

Treat It As Real

- ▶ No slides, no notes, no AI — just you and your slice.
- ▶ A stumble here is **free**; a stumble in Week 14 costs points.

The dry run is the cheapest place to fail.

Why This Matters

Week 14 is graded and cold. Today is the same, free. Every gap you close now is points you keep then.

Next: **Week 13** workshop / Q&A to finish closing gaps; **Week 14** is the real defense (with Lab 7).